



Create a River in a Sensory Tray

EXPLORE • CREATE • PLAY • LEARN

Alabama has many beautiful rivers and streams that provide water for people, animals, and plants. In this activity, you will create your own river in a sensory tray using foil, sand, or water.

Directions:

1. Gather your materials.
2. Set up a tray or shallow container.
3. Create a river using foil, sand, water, or a combination.
4. Add details like rocks, trees, animals, or a bridge.
5. Play and explore! Move the "water," test how it flows, and try different materials.
6. Be creative and have fun!

Materials You Could Use:

- Shallow tray or plastic bin
- Aluminum foil (for a river shape)
- Sand, dirt, or kinetic sand
- Water (optional)
- Rocks, pebbles, or gravel
- Toy animals, trees, or people
- Sticks, leaves, or moss
- Cups, spoons, or small containers
- Blue food coloring (if using water)
- Anything else you can think of!

Explore
Like an
Alabamian!



Ideas to Try:

- Use foil to make a winding river.
- Fill the tray with sand and carve a river path.
- Add water and see how it flows.
- Build a bridge with sticks or blocks.
- Add toy animals that live in or near Alabama's rivers (fish, turtles, herons, etc.).
- Create waterfalls, rocks, or a lake.
- Use blue glass gems, beads, or marbles for the water.
- Make labels for your river features.



Think About It...

- What did you use to make your river?
- How does the water (or pretend water) move?
- What kinds of animals might live in an Alabama river?
- Why are rivers important to Alabama?
- What is your favorite Alabama river?

"Rivers make
life possible."



"He leads me beside still waters; He restores my soul." PSALM 23:2